

with more credits (each contest win is worth a few credits, which can also be converted into cash prizes); some contests are open to all users, irrespective of their level and some contests are created by users themselves.

The site offers much more than contests, and the top bar offers links to all the resources on the site. Besides the regular contests, the site also offers tutorials. It has over 250 tutorials self created tutorials (the site rewards users who create tutorials), and about 500 links to tutorials hosted externally. It also has links to 70 video tutorials that are hosted at other video hosting sites like YouTube.com and metacafe.com. Besides tutorials, there are also Guides, which give a blow by blow account of how the contest winning entry was created (the FAQ does elaborate that every contest entry has to be accompanied by a description of the creation process). There is also a gallery containing user submitted images, which you can access from the Art link on the top bar. The gallery is divided into different sections, like Illustration, and Photo Effects, and in all contains nearly 6,000 images. The site also has a Forum. The suggestions link can be used by users to suggest themes for upcoming contests. The Resources link offers links to other sites offering related content—Photoshop tutorials, free downloadable stock photos, free downloadable brushes and textures. The Stock link offers you Royalty free photos contributed by users of the site.

6.3.2 <http://photoshopcontest.com/>

This site is similar in structure as photoshoptalent.com, which we have just seen. This site also holds regular contests that are open to all registered users. A contest is normally open for three days. Prizes vary from contest to contest, and can include free access to the Premium service of the site for a period of time or some image editing software. Besides the contests, the site has a gallery containing user submitted images. It also offers tutorials which are created in-house, though at the time of this review the tutorials were not updated and were quite old. Besides normal tutorials, there are also video tutorials on the site, which are also quite outdated. The site also has a forum.